Seven Wants to Make Ten

A bedtime story for ages 4–7 · about 4 minutes to read aloud

In the Number Lab lived a little beast called Seven. Seven had seven spots on his back and a very big wish.

"I want to make TEN," said Seven. "Tens get to ring the big golden bell."

Seven looked around the lab. Over by the window sat Two, a small blue beast with two spots.

"Will you help me make ten?" asked Seven.

Two hopped over. Seven counted their spots together: "Seven, eight, nine." He frowned. "That's only nine."

"Then we need one more," said Two.

Under the table, a tiny beast was hiding. It was One, with just one spot, and it was a little bit shy.

"Will you help us?" asked Seven gently.

One peeked out. "Me? I'm only one."

"One is exactly what we need," said Seven.

One rolled out from under the table. Seven counted again, very carefully: "Seven, eight, nine... TEN!"

DING! The big golden bell rang so loudly that all the beasts in the lab came running.

"Seven made ten!" they cheered.

"No," said Seven. "We made ten. Seven and two and one."

That night, the three beasts curled up together in a warm, spotty pile. Seven counted their spots one more time, just to be sure.

"Ten," he whispered happily. And then he counted sheep instead, and fell fast asleep.

The end.

For grown-ups: This story is about number bonds to 10, a building block of early maths. Number Beasts is a free iPhone puzzle game built around making 10, with no ads or in-app purchases. · Free story from Honest Little Apps · honestlittleapps.github.io/bedtime-stories